Rain & Rescues

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/42396498.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Mara (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Catra Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Suicide Attempt, Self-Harm, Angst and Hurt/Comfort, Angst, Hurt/Comfort, Sad with a Happy Ending, Mentioned Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner's A+ Parenting, Abusive Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

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by AstrynSerene

Summary

Silent tears fell as she prepared to let go. She was so focused on her inner thoughts and listening to the surrounding music of soft rainfall, that she missed the approaching headlights and the sound of a car pulling over.

It was the moment she finally relaxed her fingers and began to fall forward that she felt a pair of strong arms wrap around her waist and effortlessly pull her to the safety of their owner's arms, "No! Let me go!" Catra cried.

Notes

Catra speaks a little bit of Spanish in this fic. I put the translations in the end notes to save anyone who doesn't know the language from pulling up Google Translate lol.

TW// Mentioned child abuse and bullying. A slur or two is referenced in Catra's thoughts.

See the end of the work for more notes

Most kids are taught that life is precious; life is short, a show you're meant to enjoy and relish in until the curtain falls. For Catra, that was absolutely not the case. If you asked her, she'd say she had been dealt the absolute worst role in her play, and she wanted nothing more than to burn the stage and tear the curtains with her claws until they bled. Who would want to play the role of an orphaned hybrid child who was abused by her supposed caretaker and teased and beat down by almost all the kids in both her group home and surrounding classmates? Sure, maybe someone would if it was a Disney film that ended with a wedding full of happily ever afters, but that was fantasy, not reality.

No, in reality, she was mocked for her efforts to pursue her talents in art, called slurs for her race, ethnicity, and sexuality, and told she was worthless and that Etheria would be better if she wasn't in it by her caretaker. More often than not, she didn't want to continue living. What was the point in trying if everyone was just waiting for you to fail? There wasn't. Self love got her to seventeen, but that was running dangerously thin. She was left trapped in an eternal night; she needed the sun to save her from the cold, and wrap her in the safety of warmth.

Some would call it waiting on a miracle, others would call it needing a hero.

Catra would call it a glorious blonde lesbian that looks fantastic in the late night Brightmoon rain.

⚔

"Oh look, it's the magi-freak!"

"Brightmoon's Dyke! The slut we love to hate!"

"Insolent child! Disobey me again and you'll sleep in a crate like the animal you are!"

"Watch out! The zoo has an escapee!"

"Etheria doesn't need anymore freaks!"

"Rot in the Whispering Woods with the rest of your kind!"

"Ever considered jumping off of the Salineas Gate Bridge? Everyone would be much better off!"

Jump off of Salineas Gate Bridge.

Salineas Gate Bridge.

That's how the young teenage magicat wound up on said bridge. Tears stained her freckled cheeks as she watched the river flowing below her. She was tired. She was tired of the teasing, the abuse. She was tired of being seen as the dirt below everyone's feet. If this is how the rest of her life was destined to go, she didn't want to stay and watch it happen.

She hadn't even bothered to leave a note. There was nobody that would miss her. She wouldn't even be surprised if her body went undiscovered for years. That was fine by her, this body could endure one final piece of torment by resting in the thing she hated most- water.

"Come on, Catra. Just get this over with. It'll be- mostly painless, and you can be with your m-mommas again…" more tears fell at the thought of her parents. They'd been taken in a shooting at her old school in Halfmoon, teachers who died protecting their daughter and the other students they saw as part of their family. "Cierra los ojos, hija mía, y recuerda que nuestro amor por ti es eterno…" she whispered the sentence to herself, remembering it as the last thing her mother, Luna, had ever uttered to her when she held her for the final time in the hospital. She had never had the opportunity to say goodbye to her other mother, C'yra, as she was gone by the time authorities arrived on scene.

Catra looked up at the last quarter moon that shone brightly over the bridge that connected Brightmoon and Salineas. It would take her another hour's walk to reach her hometown, Halfmoon, but maybe her body would find it by river one day. Her ears fell against her head at the thought that in just a few moments, her presence on Etheria would be nothing more than just a body, no consciousness left; she had to shake her head to bring herself out

of the thought. She couldn't back down now, she didn't need to be a coward and a failure at suicide too.

The brunette took a deep breath, letting it out slowly to steady herself as she gripped onto the pole she was standing by as she finally climbed onto the railing of the bridge, now being fully faced with the thirty foot drop to the river below, "Cierra los ojos…and rest…" she spoke, again in a soft silence, the wind carrying her words as she let her eyes drift closed. Silent tears fell as she prepared to let go. She was so focused on her inner thoughts and listening to the surrounding music of soft rainfall, that she missed the approaching headlights and the sound of a car pulling over.

It was the moment she finally relaxed her fingers and began to fall forward that she felt a pair of strong arms wrap around her waist and effortlessly pull her to the safety of their owner's arms, "No! Let me go!" Catra cried, struggling, and failing to free herself, "Just let me have this! I have nothing left here!"

"Hey hey, take a deep breath." The voice was..gentle. Part of the magicat had expected the person to grab her had been Shadow Weaver, or someone sent by her to drag her back to her hell, but to her surprise, she found upon opening her eyes that the person holding her was just a random blonde girl. Not only that, but a *beautiful* random blonde girl that looked to be about her age, not that any of that mattered. She was just doing what any sane being would do when seeing another trying to kill themselves.

Finally finding her voice, albeit shaky, Catra made eye contact with the stranger, "I have…nothing left on Etheria…" she started, taking deep breaths as prompted, "There's nobody left in the entire universe who cares about me."

"I care about you." The girl's voice was so soft so- *genuine* , that Catra almost wanted to believe her. Instead, she forced a pathetic, humorless laugh.

"Yeah, okay. You don't know me. You can't care about someone you don't know. Pity? Maybe."

"You can't pity someone when you don't know their situation." The blonde fired back.

"Touché." Catra muttered. Her chest warmed at the smile (the very dorky smile) she was given at her response, "Still… you don't know me. Why would you care about a complete stranger?"

"I was raised to believe that everyone deserves kindness and love. It sounds cheesy, but kindness can go a long way, and I couldn't just drive by and watch you…jump."

"Why not? At least ten other cars did."

"Well then I hope they only did because they didn't see you. I don't know you, true, but I'm going to help you anyway. You clearly need it, and it really… it hurts me to see you look so.. sad."

Catra hadn't been shown kindness from many people in her life. After her moms, there were three kids in her group home that kind of liked her, but wouldn't bat an eye to protect her from Shadow Weaver. This was the first person since her moms that seemed to, for whatever reason, genuinely care about her well-being.

"Hey…" the blonde spoke up again after a small stretch of silence, "Why don't I bring you to my place for the night? It's just me and my sister, and I wouldn't feel right leaving you alone like this tonight."

"I…" Catra mulled over her options. It was pretty clear this girl wasn't going to take no for an answer, and there was no way in hell she was going back to Shadow Weaver tonight. Well, if she was going to be kidnapped and murdered by accepting a ride from a stranger, at least she would have the face of a goddess, "Sure…why not." She shrugged.

Smiling, the blonde led her back to her car, well- pick up truck, now that Catra was closer and could see it better through the rain. She carefully slid into the passenger seat once the door was opened for her, closing said door and buckling in while her new acquaintance situated in the driver's seat, "I'm Adora by the way." She spoke as she pulled back onto the road and continued back towards her home.

"I'm… Elizabeth, technically, but please just call me Catra."

"Alright, Catra." Adora smiled, "Feel free to adjust the temperature or music or anything, okay? It'll only be about ten to fifteen minutes back home. My sister's name is Mara, by the way."

Catra nodded. She kept to herself, almost curled up in the seat as she watched the rain land on the window and roll down to meet the door of the truck. This was not how she expected this night to go.

⚔

This was not how Adora expected her night to go.

She'd rolled her ankle at work when she was delivering an order at the Enchanted Grotto, gotten a speeding ticket on the way to said job because she was running late, and now she was having to take the long way home over the bridge because of construction-

Is that a girl on the ledge?!

Her entire brain short circuited when she got about halfway over Salineas Gate Bridge and saw a girl about her age standing on the railing, looking ready to *jump* .

Adora reacted on instinct, pulling over and getting out of her truck. She didn't bother to shut the door as she quickly made her way over and threw her arms around the girl just as she let go of the pole, and pulled her into the safety of her arms.

"No! Let me go!" The girl cried, struggling, and failing to free herself, "Just let me have this! I have nothing left here!"

"Hey hey, take a deep breath." Adora gently encouraged, keeping a hand protectively on her shoulder while the other rested around the brunette's torso.

Adora felt her heart ache at the look the poor teen gave her when she began to speak again; her voice was shaky and clearly on edge, "I have…nothing left on Etheria…" she started, taking deep breaths as Adora had prompted, "There's nobody left in the entire universe who cares about me."

"I care about you." Adora replied, admittedly kind of automatically, but she truly meant every word.

"Yeah, okay. You don't know me. You can't care about someone you don't know. Pity? Maybe."

Furrowing her eyebrows slightly at the irony of that statement, she decided to fire back one similar, "You can't pity someone when you don't know their situation." The blonde bit back, a teasing undertone in her voice.

"Touché." She smiled ever so slightly. Progress! Adora smiled a little herself, "Still… you don't know me. Why would you care about a complete stranger?"

"I was raised to believe that everyone deserves kindness and love. It sounds cheesy, but kindness can go a long way, and I couldn't just drive by and watch you…jump." Adora spoke purely on emotional drive. She'd been through mental hoops herself in her life, and had very little support, but she'd never thought of actually ending her own life, so she couldn't even imagine what this poor girl had been through to have wound up here.

"Why not? At least ten other cars did."

"Well then I hope they only did because they didn't see you. I don't know you, true, but I'm going to help you anyway. You clearly need it, and it really… it hurts me to see you look so.. sad." She meant that. Adora wasn't entirely sure why she felt so drawn to this person, but she was going to make sure that she got the help that she needed, no matter what. One thing was for certain, everyone deserves love and happiness, and if Adora could provide that for this person, then she could continue her own life feeling content. "Hey…" she spoke again after realizing they'd been in a small stretch of silence, "Why don't I bring you to my place for the night? It's just me and my sister, and I wouldn't feel right leaving you alone like this tonight."

"I…" the brunette paused, hesitating for a few minutes before finally shrugging, "Sure, why not."

Smiling, Adora slowly walked the girl back to her pick up truck, taking care to make sure she was comfortable in the passenger seat before returning to her spot in the driver's seat and beginning to drive off. That's when a realization hit, "I'm Adora by the way."

"I'm… Elizabeth, technically, but please just call me Catra."

Catra. She had a name as beautiful as her face. "Alright, Catra." Adora smiled, "Feel free to adjust the temperature or music or anything, okay? It'll only be about ten to fifteen minutes back home. My sister's name is Mara, by the way."

Once receiving a nod, Adora turned her attention back to driving and getting Catra to a safe place for the night, and however long she needed after that. As far as Adora was concerned, Catra could call her home hers as well.

Maybe tonight wasn't so bad after all.

⚔

Catra kept her eyes on her surroundings as the truck pulled into a parking lot of an apartment building. Well, at least it wasn't a house in the middle of the woods; maybe she wouldn't be murdered after all. She flinched when the vehicle came to a stop

and shut off, looking over at Adora, who offered a kind smile, "We're here." She informed the obvious. Catra only nodded as she stepped out of the truck with Adora, following her inside after the truck was locked.

Adora led Catra inside and to the second floor up the staircase. They only had to walk to the third door down before stopping for Adora to unlock the door.

The apartment was cozy, not too big, not too small. Mara was lounging on the couch, the TV turned to a random channel while she scrolled through her phone.

"Hey, Mara? I'm home- with a guest." Adora inquired, immediately getting her sister's attention.

"Who- oh! Hello!" Mara shoved her phone in her pocket and got to her feet, approaching the magicat, who suddenly felt small under these two girls, both taller than her. She wasn't sure how she felt about it, "I'm Mara! It's nice to meet you."

"I …Catra." She managed, looking at the carpeted floor against her feet.

"Well, Catra, how did you come to meet my sister?"

There was the question Catra absolutely did *not* want to answer right now, "Well I-"

"It's a really long story, Mara." Adora cut in, not wanting to put Catra in a worse mindset then she already must be in, "For now, I need to make sure she's comfortable and gets a good rest tonight, okay?"

Mara seemed to somewhat understand the situation, though could only speculate. Nodding she took a step back towards the hallway, "Gotcha. I'll give you two some space. If you need anything, I'll be in my room."

"Thanks, sis." Adora smiled gratefully, letting her leave the room before turning back to their guest, "Okay, really important question. Have you caused any-..." She silently implied what she wanted to ask by sliding her hand across her wrist, "You know..?"

Tensing, and ears falling against her head, she bit her lip and gave a tiny nod, pulling her hoodie sleeves down a little more.

"Would you be okay with me cleaning them up for you? I don't want you getting an infection from them not being cleaned and bandaged properly."

Part of her didn't want to agree to letting someone else have the ability to see her weaknesses, but she knew that Adora was only

trying to help, and she literally had nothing left to lose, "Sure… I don't wanna get blood on your bed…"

"That's the absolute least of my concerns, but thank you for the consideration. Come on, the bathroom is just over here."

"Okay…"

Following the blonde, Catra found herself sitting on the counter, pulling her hoodie over her head while Adora got some supplies from the cabinet over the toilet.

The brunette carefully laid her hoodie on her lap and watched Adora set a tube of ointment, bottle of rubbing alcohol, bandages, and a rag on the counter next to her, "I'm glad none of these are deep enough to need stitches. I'm- guessing you used your claws?"

"M-mhm.."

"Alright… just take a deep breath, this will probably sting a little. Feel free to grab my shoulders or anything if you need to, okay?"

Catra only nodded. She closed her eyes, her ears twitching a little as she listened to Adora picking up the rag and rubbing alcohol. She gasped and hissed when she felt the sting of the chemical against her wrists. She only lasted a minute before her claws

latched onto the blonde's shoulders, her nails only a little pressure away from tearing through the jacket.

Pausing immediately, Adora set the rag down and wrapped her arms around Catra, "Shh, it's alright. We can take a moment. Take a few deep breaths for me?"

Following the request, Catra took a few deep breaths to slow her racing heart. Slowly, she allowed Adora to continue.

Once cleaned, medicated, and bandaged, the blonde let Catra into her room, "We only have two bedrooms, but I can take the couch, you can stay here in my room. Come get me if you need anything." Adora smiled, before turning to go.

"Adora, wait." Catra frowned, gently grabbing her wrist. She quickly pulled away, embarrassed when she made eye contact with her, "Could you…stay? I… I really don't want to be alone tonight."

"Aw, well sure. Anything to make you more comfortable." Adora blushed herself as she accepted the request.

The two slipped into pajamas, Catra borrowing one of Adora's shirts, the pair got into bed and snuggled up against each other. It was only a twin sized mattress, so they had to be close. As the magicat got comfortable, she started to purr, "Buenas noches mamis que duerman bien.." She whispered.

"What?" Adora asked, not understanding a word. She never did well in Spanish.

"Sorry.. I just- I always tell my moms goodnight. It..helps. Spanish is our native language so it feels right to use it when I talk to them…"

Tears welled up in the blonde's eyes, "Aw.. That's so sweet and so sad…" she instinctively hugged the brunette closer, "Well, I know your moms are so proud of you."

Catra sniffed, "How would you know?"

"I know, because you're still here, fighting."

A few tears ran down Catra's face, and she continued to purr, resting her head on the blonde's chest, "Thank you…"

Adora smiled again, gently caressing Catra's hair, "Sleep well, Catra."

"You too, Adora."

The two slowly fell asleep, wrapped in each other's arms. Catra had never felt so safe, loved, and comfortable as she did in Adora's arms. She didn't know what the future would bring her, but she did know one thing. She was going to keep fighting. Her moms would want her to be happy and live, and if she could find a way to spend time with the guardian angel spooning her right now, then she would call her life one worth living.

End Notes

Spanish translations:

- "Cierra los ojos, hija mía, y recuerda que nuestro amor por ti es eterno" ; "Close your eyes, my daughter, and remember that our love for you is eternal."

- "cierra los ojos" ; "close your eyes"

- "Buenas noches mamis que duerman bien." ; "Good night moms, sleep well."

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!